NDHU Regulations for Implementing Dual-Degree Programs in Cooperation with Overseas Universities

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Article 1

In order to broaden students' perspectives, cultivate students' global outlook, and promote international academic cooperation and exchange, National Dong Hwa University (hereinafter referred to as "NDHU" or "the University") has specifically formulated this *Regulations for Implementing Dual-Degree Programs in Cooperation with Overseas Universities* (hereinafter referred to as "the Regulations") in accordance with the *University Act*, the *Regulations Regarding International Students Undertaking Studies in Taiwan*, the *Regulations Governing the Assessment and Recognition of Foreign Academic Records by Institutions of Higher Education*, the *Regulations Governing People from Mainland China Undertaking Junior College-Level Studies and Above in Taiwan*, the *Regulations Governing the Assessment and Recognition of Academic Records from Mainland China*, the *Regulations Governing Hong Kong and Macao Residents Undertaking Studies in Taiwan*, the *Regulations Governing the Examination and Recognition of Academic Records from Hong Kong and Macao*, the *NDHU Academic Regulations*, the *NDHU Guidelines for Establishing*

Written Agreements on Academic Cooperation with Overseas Educational and Research Institutions, and other relevant laws and regulations.

Article 2

The term, "Dual-Degree Program" (hereinafter referred to as "the Program"), as defined in the Regulations refers to the academic cooperation agreements signed between the University and overseas universities to assist students from both parties (or either party) to complete the required coursework at the partner university within the prescribed period of study, in accordance with the NDHU regulations and relevant bilateral education laws. Degrees will be awarded to students upon completion of the degree requirements of both universities.

The degrees awarded under the Program may be either a joint degree awarded by both universities (noted as jointly awarded on the diploma) or separate degrees of the same or different levels awarded by each university.

Article 3

The Program shall be implemented primarily with overseas universities that have established sister school relationships with the University and must meet the following requirements:

1. The overseas university must have signed a dual-degree program cooperation agreement with the University.
2. The overseas university must be recognized by the government or educational authority of the local country and listed in the *Reference List of Foreign Universities* promulgated by the Ministry of Education.
3. Mainland Chinese universities must be listed in the *Reference List of Universities and Higher Education Institutions in Mainland China* promulgated by the Ministry of Education.

Article 4

Each academic unit of the University (e.g., departments, institutes, degree programs), in cooperation with an overseas university, shall prepare a bilingual (Chinese and English) cooperation agreement for dual-degree programs. This agreement shall be co-signed by the relevant college, the Office of

Academic Affairs (hereinafter referred to as “the OAA”), and the Office of International Affairs (hereinafter referred to as “the OIA”), and approved by the President of the University before being signed by the President or an authorized supervisor.

However, the cooperation agreement between the University and universities in Mainland China may be exempted from the English version requirement, but must comply with the *Guidelines Governing the Assessment of Alliances or Written Agreements on Cooperative Behaviors between Schools at All Levels and Schools in Mainland China* formulated by the Ministry of Education. The agreement must be submitted to the Ministry of Education for approval prior to signing.

The content of the dual-degree program cooperation agreement must include the following items:

1. Application Qualification
2. Curriculum Design
3. Credit Waiver
4. Length of Study
5. Degree Conferral
6. Tuition Fees and Enrollment Ratio
7. Termination Provisions of the Agreement
8. Thesis supervision (undergraduate programs may be exempt)
9. Other necessary matters.

The provisions of Paragraph 8 should include requirements for qualifying examinations, language used in the thesis and abstract, publication of the thesis, and intellectual property rights for master's and doctoral theses.

Article 5

Each department, institute, or degree program of the University may formulate specific courses for the Program in cooperation with overseas universities as needed. These courses, along with the required subjects and credits, must be reviewed and approved by the University Curriculum Committee and the Academic Affairs Meeting prior to implementation.

Article 6

Students enrolled in the Program under the Regulations must meet the following length requirements, in addition to complying with the NDHU regulations, when accumulating study time at both universities:

1. For a Bachelor's degree, the total length of study at both universities should be at least 32 months.
2. For a Master's degree, the total length of study at both universities should be at least 12 months.
3. For a Ph.D. degree, the total length of study at both universities should be at least 24 months.

In addition to the *NDHU Academic Regulations*, students enrolled in a cross-level dual-degree program must comply with the provisions of the of the *Regulations Governing the Assessment and Recognition of Academic Records from Mainland China*, and the *Regulations Governing the Examination and Recognition of Academic Records from Hong Kong and Macao*.

Article 7

For students enrolled in the Program under the Regulations, the length of study and the number of credits earned at both universities may be combined. The number of credits earned at each university must be at least one-third of the total credits required for degree conferral at each university. Whether the student is required to register for the final semester or academic year at the University is determined by the department, institute, or degree program, as specified in the agreement in accordance with Article 6 of the Regulations.

Article 8

Overseas partner universities cooperating with the University in the Program shall prepare a list of recommended students and submit it to the OIA by the specified deadline. The recommended students from the overseas partner universities must apply for admission through the University's established channels for overseas degree students (international students, overseas Chinese students including Hong Kong and Macau students, and Mainland Chinese students) and prepare the

necessary application documents (or other documents as specified in the agreement) for admission.

Article 9

Overseas students who are admitted to study at the University under the Program and who meet the qualifications of Mainland Chinese students, overseas Chinese students including Hong Kong and Macau students, or international students shall be administered in accordance with the relevant laws and regulations and the *NDHU Academic Regulations* in terms of registration, student status, performance evaluation, scholarships, accommodation, and student life guidance.

Article 10

Overseas students admitted to the Program at the University may apply for transfer of courses and credits successfully completed at their home university, in accordance with the *NDHU Regulations of Credit Waiver*.

Article 11

Overseas students admitted to a dual Master's degree program at the University, who have completed at least one year of study and who have demonstrated excellent academic performance, may apply for direct admission to the Ph.D. program at the University in accordance with the *NDHU Directions for Direct Admission to Ph.D. Programs*. However, a student’s eligibility to pursue a dual Ph.D. degree will be determined in accordance with the agreement between the two universities.

Article 12

Students of the University who wish to study at an overseas partner university during the course of their studies must meet the admission requirements of the overseas partner university and submit an application to their department, institute, or degree program at the University. Once approved by the overseas partner university, the department, institute, or degree program must submit the

application, co-signed by the appropriate college, the OAA, and the OIA, to the President or an authorized supervisor for approval prior to processing study abroad arrangements.

Article 13

Students of the University who enroll in the Program at an overseas university must pay the full tuition and other fees to the University during each semester of their study abroad. The subjects and credits successfully completed at the overseas university may be transferred in accordance with the *NDHU Regulations of Credit Waiver*. Upon approval of the transfer of credits, and if the student meets the graduation requirements of his/her department or institute, the student will be awarded a degree from the University.

Article 14

If a student of the University enrolled in the Program at an overseas university is unable to complete his/her studies at the overseas university for any reason, and the total period of study at both universities has not exceeded the maximum period of study prescribed by the University, the student may apply to return to his/her original department or institute at the University at an appropriate grade level. The request, including a report and relevant supporting documents, must be submitted to the OAA at least two weeks before the start of classes for the semester, as specified in the University's academic calendar. The subjects and credits successfully completed at the overseas university may be transferred in accordance with the *NDHU Regulations of Credit Waiver*.

Article 15

All other matters not set forth in the Regulations shall be handled in accordance with applicable regulations of the Ministry of Education and the University.

Article 16

The Regulations have been approved at the Academic Affairs Meeting prior to its implementation,

and have been filed with the Ministry of Education for references.

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